CHECKLIST

SKI AREA OPENING DAY CHECKLIST

One owner per department. Start the "weeks before" items four to six weeks out, and read the "morning of" items aloud at the stand-up.

Mountain: General manager: Opening date:

This checklist is a template. Have your insurer and attorney review it before adopting, and follow your lift manufacturers' manuals and your state's rules first.

THE OPENING DAY CHECKLIST, BY DEPARTMENT

Lifts

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Annual inspection** and any state or third-party inspection done, with the papers on file
- [ ] **Load tests and maintenance** required by the manufacturer complete, and open work orders closed or scheduled
- [ ] **Operators and attendants trained** on each lift, with the training documented
- [ ] **Evacuation plan** reviewed for every lift, and an evacuation drill run

Morning of

- [ ] **Daily pre-opening inspection** on every lift, signed (use the chairlift inspection checklist)
- [ ] **Wind and icing** checked against each lift's limits
- [ ] **Mazes, ramps and signs** set at every load and unload
- [ ] **Radios** tested between stations and with patrol

Ski patrol

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Patrol roster** built, with every patroller's certifications current
- [ ] **Medical supplies, toboggans and the patrol room** stocked and checked
- [ ] **Lift evacuation training** current for patrollers on duty at each lift
- [ ] **Lost child procedure** reviewed with patrol, ski school and lift staff (see the lost child procedure)

Morning of

- [ ] **Patrol on duty** signed in with stations and radios
- [ ] **Opening checks** on every run to open: hazards marked, ropes, signs and padding
- [ ] **Closed terrain** roped and signed, with the reason recorded
- [ ] **Closing sweep routes** assigned for the end of the day

Terrain park

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Features** inspected, repaired and listed, with sizes
- [ ] **Park layout** planned for the snow you have, with each area's size rating
- [ ] **Signs** ready: entrance, Park SMART or code sign, and size signs

Morning of

- [ ] **Every feature placed today inspected** (use the terrain park inspection checklist)
- [ ] **A test ride** on every jump and rail
- [ ] **The supervisor signs off** each park area before it opens

Snowmaking and grooming

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Snowmaking** plan for the opening terrain, with guns, pumps and lines serviced
- [ ] **Groomers and snowmobiles** serviced and their pre-shift checks done

- [ ] **Operators** trained on each machine

Morning of

- [ ] **Overnight grooming** finished on every opening run, and recorded
- [ ] **Snow depth, new snow and surface** recorded for the morning report
- [ ] **Snowmaking equipment** cleared from open runs, or marked and padded

Ticketing and the online shop

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Prices** set for every product, age group and day, with blackout dates
- [ ] **Online shop** tested with a real purchase and a refund
- [ ] **Daily limits** set if you cap opening day sales
- [ ] **Waiver wording** reviewed and live online and at the counter
- [ ] **Card readers, gates and scanners** tested

Morning of

- [ ] **Tills** counted and opened
- [ ] **Will-call** ready for online orders
- [ ] **Gate scanners** on at every lift that scans

Rentals

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Fleet** tuned, counted and tagged
- [ ] **Binding technicians** trained, with your shop's settings chart ready
- [ ] **Reservations** open, with sizing taken ahead

Morning of

- [ ] **Counter stations** set up, with sizing and waiver checks ready
- [ ] **Reserved gear** pulled and labeled

Ski school

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Lessons** scheduled for the opening days, with prices and class sizes
- [ ] **Online booking** open and tested
- [ ] **Instructors** hired, certifications recorded, pay rates set (see how to build a pay scale)
- [ ] **Pickup and release policy** published to families (see the pickup policy template)

Morning of

- [ ] **Rosters** printed or on phones, with pickup lists
- [ ] **Meeting places** signed
- [ ] **Lineup** run, with classes within their size

Staff and scheduling

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Opening week schedule** published, with every shift filled
- [ ] **Certifications** required for each position current
- [ ] **Time clock** set up, with every new hire able to clock in
- [ ] **Orientation** held for new staff, including the emergency and lost child procedures

Morning of

- [ ] **Everyone clocked in**, and no-shows covered
- [ ] **Morning stand-up** held with each department's owner

Guest communication

Owner:

Weeks before

- [ ] **Opening date** announced to pass holders and past guests who agreed to hear from you
- [ ] **Website** updated: hours, prices, what will be open, parking
- [ ] **Conditions** on your website set up to show lifts, trails and grooming

Morning of

- [ ] **Morning report** posted: lifts, runs, grooming, snow and weather
- [ ] **Front-line staff** told what is open, so every answer is the same